



democratising the Internet. So, many more people can now access it. Therefore, it will be fair to say that smartphones and similar personal devices are disruptive innovations.

However, if you think about artificial intelligence (AI), most AI-related products or services promise a reduction in input while increasing the output significantly. That is classic efficiency innovation. Due to all the glamour around AI technology, people try to dub it as a disruptive technology. It may work well because of a disruption in the economy, but it is certainly not a disruptive innovation. AI-related products and services are not disruptive innovations. These are efficiency innovations, and as long as businesses understand this difference, they can make appropriate and right decisions.

If you have been wondering which innovation is the best one, the answer is not singular. All types of innovations have a place in business and economy. Having the right balance is important for all of them. The good thing here is, when you have cash and jobs released from efficiency innovation, you can turn those jobs and cash towards disruptive innovation. So, while doing efficiency innovation projects in your company, always look for an opportunity to invest and reroute that cash and jobs in disruptive innovation.

Disruptive innovation should

closely follow efficiency innovation for economic stability and sustainable growth!

The new kind of innovation

The fourth type of innovation, which I mentioned earlier, is different from all the three types we have discussed so far.

Take the case of a car brand such as Volkswagen, BMW, Tata, Maruti, or Tesla. All of them are in the 'What' category. What do they enable you to do? They enable you to commute from place A to place B.

The 'How' part of the commute was changed by Uber, Lyft, Ola, and some others like them. They still enable you to go from place A to place B, but you can now easily hire instead of driving yourself or owning a car. So, 'what you do' remains the same, but 'how you do it' has changed.

Now, instead of 'What' or 'How,' if you focus on 'Why' your answer will change. When you ask why someone needs to go from place A to place B, it will give you different perspectives and ideas. Knowing 'Why' behind the use of the service or product will help you identify a new product or new positioning, even both.

If you focus on your company's purpose and the value you want to deliver to your customers, your outlook will change. You will ask, "What is my customer trying to achieve?" This approach will make you think



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